“No, it doesn’t. But if you didn’t carry her full term, she would have never had a chance. At least you gave her that. It was all you had to give. What happened to her isn’t your fault. If the war had ended earlier, she’d be alive.”

Maria leaned into Léa’s chest. “I want her back. Please. Why did she have to die?” Her body shook with silent sobs.

Holding Maria tight, Léa shut her eyes. If only she could take this pain from her. But she couldn’t, not ever. It would be a pain she’d bear for the rest of their lives.

Léa wondered whether Maria was right, and it would have been less cruel not to have intervened. Yet Josef had told her of the many babies who never had a chance to live, and at least Ewa had her chance. She wished she could have protected her from the dangers after she entered the world, but that wasn’t in her power. Was it in anybody’s?

Léa and Josef had tried to save a life. In the end, they’d failed. Was it wrong to try? Maybe. As the war dragged on, the lines between right and wrong grew increasingly blurred, and Léa wondered if one day she would be unable to tell them apart.